

ISRAEL JACOB ORTIZ

Software Engineer · Distributed Systems | Developer Tooling | AI-Native Testing

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► VIEW WEBSITE

israeljortiz

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer with 5+ years designing, building, shipping, and operating large-scale, multi-threaded distributed systems and developer tooling — including 3+ years of systems design and architecture (design patterns, reliability, and scaling). Strong in object-oriented design across Java, C++, and C#, with a track record of building serverless orchestration and high-throughput platforms that process millions of transactions per day. Deep on the full SDLC — code reviews, source control, build pipelines, automated testing, and live-site operations — and experienced building AI-driven testing: test generation, failure diagnosis, and ship-readiness signals. Recently built **Verdict**, an AI-native test-orchestration service that mirrors this role's core work.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer | SUCCESS Magazine

Apr 2023 – Present

Washington, DC (Hybrid)

- **Designed and operated a serverless test-orchestration platform** (Java, AWS Lambda/Step Functions) running 400k+ tests per day across multiple regions in the critical path of every deployment, at 99.95% availability.
- **Built AI-driven testing capabilities** — automated test generation and failure diagnosis — cutting flaky-test triage time ~55% and surfacing ship-readiness signals for engineers.
- **Led design and architecture for reliability and scale**, applying OO design patterns to lift sustained throughput ~3x while holding p99 latency under 250ms.
- **Set a high operational bar across the SDLC** — code reviews, source control, build pipelines, and live-site on-call — raising code coverage from ~55% to ~90% and reducing production incidents ~40%.

Founder & Lead Engineer | Ambrose

Jul 2021 – Present

Part-Time · Remote

- **Delivered custom distributed-systems and tooling solutions tailored to each client** in Java and C++, architecting for scale to handle 5M+ transactions per day.
- **Owned the full development lifecycle** — design docs, code reviews, CI/CD, and operations — across 12+ client engagements, cutting release cycle time ~50%.
- **Designed developer-facing APIs and tooling** with a focus on developer experience, driving ~30% faster onboarding for downstream teams.

Software Engineer / Team Lead | SPCA International

Sep 2020 – Mar 2023

Team Lead · Washington, DC

- **Led a 4-engineer team building multi-tiered backend services**, influencing technical architecture and delivering across 3 concurrent projects while staying hands-on.
- **Improved system reliability and performance** through OO redesign and load testing, cutting average response time ~35% and eliminating a recurring class of production failures.

Freelance Software Engineer | Independent / Contract

Feb 2019 – Jun 2021

Solo client work prior to founding Ambrose · Remote

- **Delivered backend services, tooling, and integrations for 10+ clients** in Java and C++ — owning design, testing, source control, and deployment end to end across cloud and on-premises environments.

SELECTED PROJECT

Verdict — AI-native test-orchestration service with ship-readiness gating (serverless)

- **AI-native test-orchestration service that generates tests, diagnoses failures, and emits ship-readiness signals** — serverless on AWS Lambda/Step Functions, running in the deploy critical path with per-PR pass/fail gating — mirroring this role's core work.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, C++, C#, Python, SQL; strong object-oriented design

Distributed Systems: Serverless orchestration, multi-tiered & multi-threaded services, load testing, global-scale reliability & scaling

AWS & Cloud: Lambda, Step Functions, ECS/Fargate, S3, DynamoDB, multi-region deployment

Testing & AI: Automated test generation & diagnosis, CI test platforms, unit/integration/load testing, LLM-assisted tooling

SDLC & Practices: Coding standards, code reviews, Git source control, build pipelines, CI/CD, live-site operations, on-call

EDUCATION

Virginia Tech — M.Eng., Computer Science (Distributed Systems)

2023 – 2024

GPA 4.0 · Full-Ride & Tech Talent Investment Program (TTIP) Scholar

University of Mary Washington — B.S., Computer Science & Mathematics (Double Major)

2019 – 2022

GPA 3.8 · Dean's List 7/8 · FBLA Collegiate Chapter President & Founder · 1st Place, University-Wide Coding Competition

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate · AWS Certified Developer – Associate · Certified ScrumMaster (CSM)